Ilanjeral. King held a daily durbar (*naal-avai*) at which he heard and resolved all the disputes. The income to the state was through taxation. Land tax was the main source of revenue and it was called '*Irai'.* This apart, the state collected tolls and customs (*sungam*), tributes and fines.

The kings and soldiers wore the heroic anklet (Veera kazhal). On the anklet, the name and achievement of the wearer were blazoned. Spies were used not only to find out what was happening within the country, but also in foreign countries.

A wound in the back was considered a disgrace and there are instances of kings fasting unto death because they had suffered such a wound in the battle.

The Court

The king's court was called *Arasavai.* The king occupied a ceremonious throne in the court called *Ariyanai*. In the court, the king was surrounded by officials, distinguished visitors and court poets. The rulers had five-fold duties. They were encouraging learning, performing rituals, presenting gifts, protecting people and punishing the criminals. Ambassadors were employed by the kings. They played a significant role. The king was assisted by a number of officials. They were divided into *Aimperunguzhu* (five-member committee) and *Enberaayam* (eight-member group).

Army

The king's army consisted of four divisions, namely, infantry, cavalry, elephants and chariot force. The army was known as '*Padai'.* The chief of the army was known as *Thanaithalaivan.* The prominent weapons used during this period were sword, *kedayam* (shield), *tomaram* (lance), spears, bows and arrows. *Tomaram* is mentioned as a missile to be thrown at the enemy from a distance. The place where the weapons were kept was known as *paddaikottil*. The forts were protected by deep moats and trenches. The war drum was worshipped as a deity.

Law and Justice

The king was the final authority for appeal. In the capital town, the court of justice was called *Avai*. In the villages, *Mandram* served as the place for dispensing justice. Punishment was always severe. Execution was ordered for theft cases. The punishment awarded for other crimes included beheading, mutilation of the offending limbs of the body, torture and imprisonment and imposition of fines.

Local Administration

The entire kingdom was called *Mandalam*. Mandalam was divided into *Nadus*. *Kurram* was subdivision of Nadu. The *Ur* was a village, classified into *perur* (big village), *Sirur* (a small village) and *Mudur* (an old village) depending upon its population, size and antiquity. *Pattinam* was the name for a coastal town and *Puhar* was the general term for harbour town.

Important Towns

Puhar, Uraiyur, Korkai, Madurai, Muziri, Vanji or Karur and Kanchi.

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